

Who were the Vikings?

The Vikings lived in Scandinavia, in northern Europe, more than 1,000 years ago. They were fierce warriors known for their attacks and raids, but they also traded and made long journeys to different parts of the world. Their warships, called longboats, had a sail to cross oceans, but could also be rowed up rivers.

Big and bright...

Longships had one large sail made from thick woolen cloth.

It is thought that sails were patterned with bright stripes.

A fearsome sight

Vikings carved and attached wooden heads of fearsome creatures, such as dragons, to the front of their longships.

Viking travelers

The Vikings were the first people to live in Iceland and they sailed even farther to Greenland and North America. Many set up homes in the places they reached.

Viking warriors



"Viking" comes from an old Norwegian word, **vikingr**, which means "sea-raider."

Armor plating...

Rowers lined up their shields along the sides of the boat for protection.

